



Cadets in Moscow. Children in Russia are indoctrinated through lessons and extracurricular activities built around military themes.

Kennedy’s Bid For Presidency Jolts Camelot

By PETER BAKER
WASHINGTON — Jack Schlossberg had had enough. The only grandson of President John F. Kennedy, Mr. Schlossberg had been watching the presidential campaign of his cousin Robert F. Kennedy Jr. with increasing dismay.

To Mr. Schlossberg, the quixotic challenge to President Biden for the Democratic nomination was a “vanity project” that was tarnishing the legacy of his grandfather and their storied family. Just days earlier last month, his conspiracy-minded cousin had suggested that the Covid-19 virus had been engineered to protect Ashkenazi Jews and Chinese people.

Sitting in a van in Australia, where he was on vacation, Mr. Schlossberg wrote a few bullet points, took out his phone and recorded a harsh condemnation of his cousin on Instagram. “He’s trading in on Camelot, celebrity, conspiracy theories and conflict for personal gain and fame,” Mr. Schlossberg said. “I’ve listened to him. I know him. I have no idea why anyone thinks he should be president. What I do know is his candidacy is an embarrassment.” Then he hit the post button.

Mr. Schlossberg’s denunciation underscored the turmoil inside what remains of Camelot.

Bobby, as the 69-year-old candidate is called, has become a source of deep anguish among his many siblings, cousins, nieces and nephews, one that is testing the bonds of what was once known as the royal family of American politics. His relatives by and large do not want him to run, do not support his campaign, disdain his conspiratorial musings and almost universally admire Mr. Biden, a longtime friend of the family who keeps a bust of Robert F. Kennedy Sr. in the Oval Office.

Yet even as some members of the candidate’s family feel compelled to speak out against his campaign, others find themselves profoundly pained by the airing of domestic discord. They do not share Bobby’s views on many issues, particularly his strident anti-vaccine stances, these Kennedys say, but they care for him, do not want to see him hurt and do not think it helps to publicly criticize him.

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Too Many Police? An Uneasy Alliance in Austin.

By J. DAVID GOODMAN
AUSTIN, Texas — Scores of state highway troopers, usually found on roadways across Texas in their distinctive cowboy hats and black-and-white patrol vehicles, have descended on Austin, the state capital.

At first, they were welcomed by the city’s Democratic leaders, part of a plan to address violent crime and make up for a shortage of more than 300 officers in the Austin Police Department.

But in a booming city known for its progressive politics, the partnership between the local police, steeped in the language of reform, and the Texas Department of Pub-

Texas Troopers Bolster Shorthanded Force, but Rift Emerges

lic Safety, under the direction of Republican state leaders, soon began to raise concern.

Statistics emerged showing that those arrested on misdemeanor charges by state troopers were mostly Black and Hispanic. In May, there was a fatal shooting by troopers after a chase. In July, another trooper shot at a fleeing, unarmed man, wounding him. Days later, two troopers drew

their weapons on a father and son during a car stop.

After that stop, Austin’s mayor suspended the partnership with the state police. But instead of the troopers leaving, they were joined by dozens more when Gov. Greg Abbott, a Republican, ordered a fresh deployment.

Now Austin has entered an uncertain and uneasy new period in which two separate law enforcement agencies, with differing approaches to policing, are patrolling the streets without formal coordination. One answers to city leaders. The other to Mr. Abbott.

“We are feeling overpoliced — that’s the feedback that got back

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QUINN ROONEY/GETTY IMAGES

Shock after the United States team lost to Sweden, failing to reach the semifinals for the first time.

U.S. Reign at World Cup Ends ‘by a Millimeter’

By ANDREW DAS
MELBOURNE, Australia — Even the replay required a second look, so slim was the margin that separated the United States from elimination at the Women’s World Cup on Sunday.

But there it was, if you squinted: Years of work, weeks of games and almost three hours of world-class soccer reduced to a single computer-generated im-

age, the ball microscopically over the goal line, and the United States fully, and unequivocally, out of the World Cup.

“We just lost the World Cup by a millimeter,” goalkeeper Alyssa Naeher said. “That’s tough.”

The decision was a stunning end in every possible way. That it gave Sweden a victory in a penalty shootout and a berth in the quarterfinals against Japan almost felt like an afterthought,

though surely not to the Swedes.

Yet as they raced off into the corner, delirious in victory, there was so much else to process: soccer’s newfound reliance on technology and video review; the elimination of the United States, the two-time reigning champion

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LEGACY Megan Rapinoe leaves a mark beyond the field. PAGE D6

Desire Behind Putin’s War: Wider Conflict With West

An Appeal to History and Nationalism That Rouses Many and Frightens Some

By ROGER COHEN | Photographs by NANNA HEITMANN
ULAN-UDE, Russia — Through towering pine forests and untouched meadows, the road to Lake Baikal in southern Siberia winds past cemeteries where bright plastic flowers mark the graves of Russians killed in Ukraine. Far from the Potemkin paradise of Moscow, the war is ever visible.

On the eastern shore of the lake, where white-winged gulls plunge into the steel-blue water, Yulia Rolikova, 35, runs an inn that doubles as a children’s summer camp. She is some 3,500 miles from the front, yet the war reverberates in her family and in her head.

“My ex-husband wanted to go fight — he claimed it was his duty,” she said. “I said, ‘No, you have an 8-year-old daughter, and it’s a much more important duty to be a father to her.’”

“People are dying there in Ukraine for nothing,” she said.

He finally understood and stayed, she told me, with a look that said: Mine is just another ordinary Russian life. That is to say the life of a single mother in a country with one of the highest divorce rates in the world, a nation plunged into an intractable war, fighting a neighboring state that President Vladimir V. Putin deemed a fiction, where tens of millions of Russians, like herself, have ties of family, culture and history.

I spent a month in Russia, a country almost as large as the United States and Canada combined, searching for clues that might explain its nationalist lurch into an unprovoked war and its mood more than 17 months into a conflict conceived as a lightning strike, only to become a lingering nightmare. The war, which has transformed the world as radically as 9/11 did, has now taken 200,000 lives since Feb. 24, 2022, roughly split between the two sides, American diplomats in Moscow estimate.

As I traveled from Siberia to

Belgorod on Russia’s western border with Ukraine, across the vertigo-inducing vastness that informs Russian assertiveness, I found a country uncertain of its direction or meaning, torn between the glorious myths that Mr. Putin has cultivated and everyday struggle.

Along the way, I encountered fear and fervid bellicosity, as well as stubborn patience to see out a long war. I found that Homo sovieticus, far from dying out, has lived on in modified form, along with habits of subservience. So with the aid of relentless propaganda on state television, the old Putin playbook — money, myth-making and menace of murder — has just about held.

But I also heard ambivalent voices like Ms. Rolikova’s, along with a few raised in outright dissent, especially from young people in a country with a stark generational divide.

It was this restiveness, this impatience with the seeming incoherence of the war and with the insouciance of the privileged in Moscow and St. Petersburg, that formed the backdrop to the short-lived revolt led by Yevgeny V. Prigozhin, the founder of the Wagner group, in late June. It was not for nothing that he named his uprising the “march for justice.”

“That Prigozhin rebelled was symptomatic of many social problems, but the way he advanced toward Moscow unhindered also demonstrated nervousness about whether all army units would fight,” said Alexander Baunov, a senior fellow at the Carnegie Russia Eurasia Center. “Putin clearly did not want to give an order to fire he was unsure would be implemented.”

Making a martyr of Mr. Prigozhin

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MORE BRIDGES HIT Ukraine has grown bolder, attacking ships and firing drones at Moscow. PAGE A5

Trash Talk Across the Hudson In a Congestion Pricing Fight

By TRACEY TULLY
Even by New Jersey standards, a news conference Gov. Philip D. Murphy held to announce that he was suing the Biden administration over New York’s plan to charge drivers to enter Midtown Manhattan was heavy on hyperbole.

A U.S. senator accused New York of orchestrating a “shake-down” of New Jersey commuters. A Democratic congressman implied that the fall from grace of New York’s former governor Andrew Cuomo was karmic payback for his support for the new tolls, known as congestion pricing. Another accused the head of North America’s largest mass transit system of giving children cancer.

“I feel like the Ginsu knife commercial,” Mr. Murphy, a Democrat, quipped — referring to a 1980s “wait, there’s more!” ad for a kitchen tool with many uses — as he added that New Jersey would pay a bonus to any state resident who worked remotely for a New York company and successfully sued to recoup out-of-state income taxes.

The gloves are off in a long-simmering border war between New York and New Jersey. And this latest battle has given rise to a curious new set of allies and enemies, allegations of hypocrisy and vivid trash talk — a situation that may grow only more intense as the start of congestion pricing nears, possibly in May next year.

Pro-Climate Governor Supports Drivers

Mr. Murphy, a self-proclaimed environmentalist with national ambitions, is trying to block a plan that seeks to address climate change. He is suing a transportation department controlled by President Biden, an ally, and headed by Pete Buttigieg, a once and future presidential contender.

New Jersey, a state run by Democrats, hired Randy Mastro — Rudy Giuliani’s chief of staff and deputy mayor when Mr. Giuliani was the Republican mayor of New York City — to file the lawsuit. Two days after Mr. Murphy’s announcement, Staten Island’s Republican borough president announced that he, too, would sue, praising Mr. Murphy’s leadership.

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QUINN ROONEY/GETTY IMAGES

The Lincoln Tunnel between New York and New Jersey.

INTERNATIONAL A4-13

‘Barbie’ Tickle China Pink
The movie has exceeded box office expectations, as female moviegoers celebrate its central theme. PAGE A12

In Egypt, Tutors Get Rich
In a country that poorly funds its public schools, families prefer to scrimp and pay for private education. PAGE A4



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His Honor, the Flag Waver
Mayor Eric Adams of New York has raised the banners of at least 31 countries since taking office, a civic gesture with political benefits. PAGE A15

Rocket City Reverse
Huntsville, Ala., which has a proud history of aerospace innovation, was set to welcome Space Command, until politics intervened. PAGE A14

Is ‘Woke’ Tiring G.O.P. Voters?
New polling showed that national Republicans and caucusgoers in Iowa were more interested in “law and order” issues. PAGE A16

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A State Left Behind
Nevada has the highest unemployment rate in the country. Officials say the economy must move away from its focus on gambling. PAGE B1

Facial Recognition Failure
A Detroit resident arrested in a carjacking is the first U.S. woman known to be wrongfully accused as a result of the technology. PAGE B1

Automakers’ Labor Showdown
The U.A.W. presented companies with several demands, including wage increases. The union is prepared to strike if they are not met. PAGE B1

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Inviting the Audience to Dance
The Broadway musical “Here Lies Love” is a rare production that puts theatergoers in motion. PAGE C1

Getting an Earful
At the Santa Fe Opera, one of the oldest works to see is also the freshest. Below, Rolando Villazón in “Orfeo.” PAGE C1



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Biles Is Back, and in Form
The star gymnast won the U.S. Classic, her first elite competition since exiting the Tokyo Olympics in 2021. PAGE D2

A Family, Representing
Jaren Jackson Jr. is a vice president in the N.B.A. players’ union, following a tradition set by his parents. PAGE D3

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Steven Brill PAGE A21

